

riches, honor and a long life. But the riches God refers to is not just money. He says, I would desire that you would have peace along with your riches.

If you don't settle early in your marriage that money is *never* going to make you happy, you'll spend your entire life doing urgent things, rather than important things, and find at age 70 that you spent your whole life chasing after the Joneses, only to discover that when you finally caught up with them, they had refinanced.

I have counseled many people throughout the years. Some were senior citizens who went from marriage to marriage themselves, and then saw their children go from marriage to marriage. Most of them looked back on their lives with great regret. Often they said, "If only I had heard that 50 years ago. If only somebody had sat me down and told me what to do, what a difference it would have made in my life." Well, maybe it would have and maybe it wouldn't have, but at least *you* have the opportunity to hear truth now!

The principles and practices that we're going to discuss are not just suggestions from God's Word. They are truths that you must apply to your life. They help to focus your life on doing important things, not just urgent things. The urgent things include your job, a new car, a bigger home, a better vacation. The important things are how you're investing your lives together, husband and wife, and what kind of a spiritual legacy you'll leave your children's children. "A good man leaves an inheritance to his children's children" (Proverbs 13:22).

It's interesting that Jesus lived among a generation of people that had very little money. In fact, Matthew was probably one of the few disciples who had any money at all, because he had been a tax collector. Yet, in teaching those men, Jesus consistently developed His parables (a teaching technique where a well-known topic is used to relate to a little-understood topic) around the handling of money. Jesus chose money because it is a common denominator among all people, regardless of age, sex, or race.